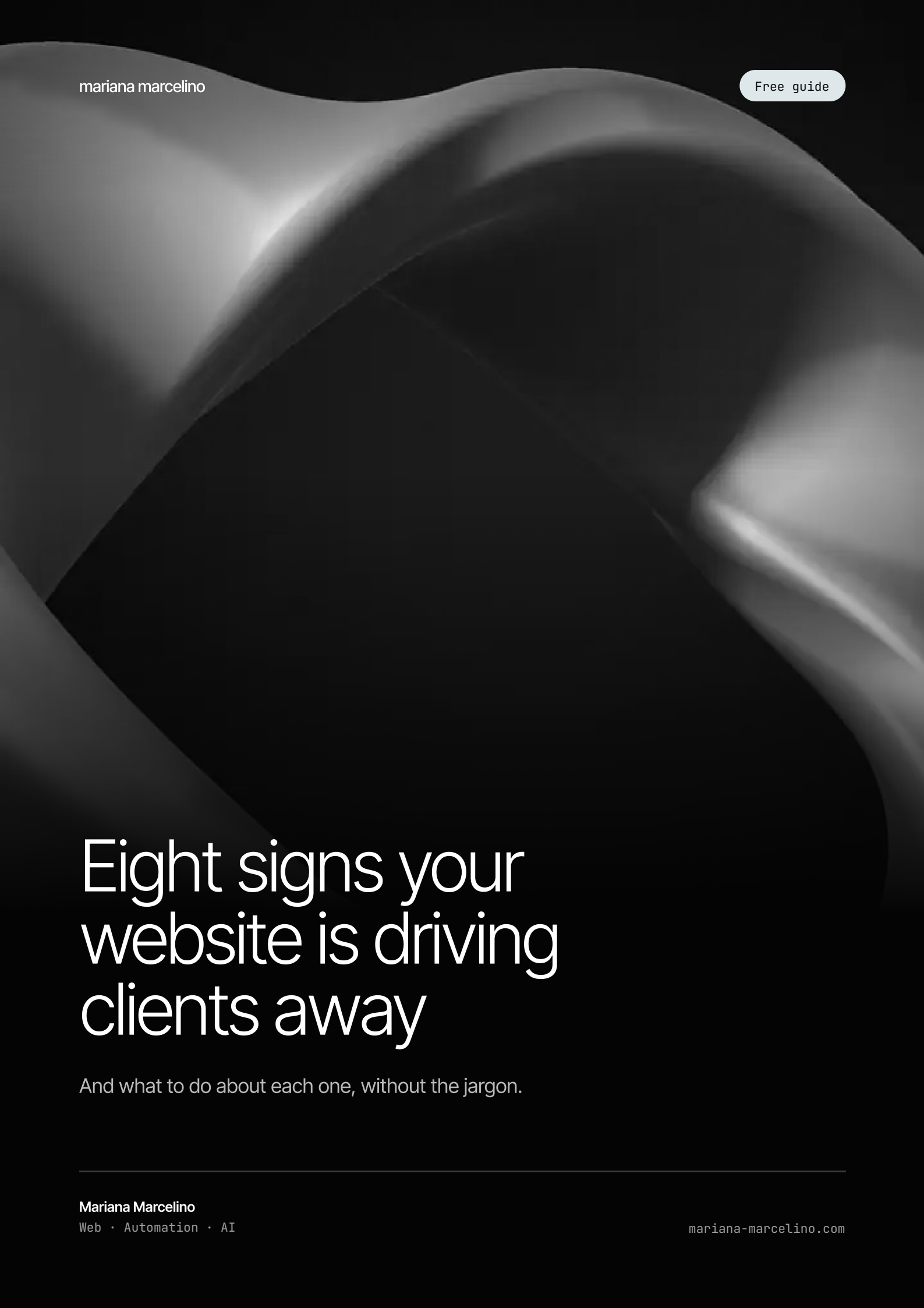


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Free guide

Eight signs your website is driving clients away

And what to do about each one, without the jargon.

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A website rarely breaks in a visible way

It simply stops working: visitors keep coming, but enquiries drop and nobody quite knows why.

This guide brings together the eight most common signs that this is happening. For each one, I explain why it matters, what to do and a quick test you can run today.

Go through the eight signs and tick the ones you recognise on your website. At the end, your count will help you decide what to do next.

How to use it

01 Read each sign with your website open next to you.

02 Run the quick test and tick the box if you recognise the problem.

03 Count your ticks and check the result on the last page.

01 It’s hard to use on a phone

02 It’s slow to load

03 It’s not clear what you do within five seconds

04 There’s no clear next step

05 The design looks dated

06 Getting in touch takes effort

07 People can’t find you on Google or AI tools

08 You can’t update it yourself

01

It’s hard to use on a phone

Most visits come from phones. If people need to zoom, the buttons are tiny or the menu misbehaves, they leave before understanding what you offer.

What to do

- Text readable without zooming (16px or more)
- Buttons with enough room for a thumb
- A simple menu, with contact always at hand

Quick test

- [ ] Open your website on your phone and try to contact yourself. Can you do it in under a minute?

02

It’s slow to load

Every second of waiting makes visitors more likely to go back. Google takes speed into account too.

What to do

- Compress and resize your images
- Remove plugins and scripts you don’t use
- Check that your hosting is up to the job

Quick test

- [ ] Test your website at pagespeed.web.dev. Is the mobile score green?

03 It’s not clear what you do within five seconds

A generic slogan makes visitors search. Most don’t: they leave.

What to do

- A headline that says what you do, for whom and where
- A subheading with your main benefit
- An image of your real work

Quick test

- [ ] Show your homepage to someone for five seconds. Can they explain what you do?

04 There’s no clear next step

Interested visitors need to know what to do next. With five equal options, or none, the decision gets postponed.

What to do

- Choose one main action per page
- Make it visible without scrolling
- Repeat it at the end of each key section

Quick test

- [ ] On each page, what is the one thing you want visitors to do? Is it obvious?

05

The design looks dated

A dated look says the business has stood still, even when it hasn't. And trust is decided at first glance.

What to do

- Use real photos of your team, space and work
- Update old dates, copy and references
- Simplify: fewer elements, more space

Quick test

☐ Does your footer still say "© 2019"? Do your photos look like stock images?

06

Getting in touch takes effort

Long forms, a hidden email address or having to call during office hours are needless obstacles.

What to do

- Cut the form down to name, email and message
- Offer WhatsApp, online booking or chat
- Say when you'll reply, and keep to it

Quick test

☐ How many clicks and fields does it take to send you a request?

07

People can’t find you on Google or AI tools

A website nobody finds doesn’t bring enquiries. If you don’t show up when people search for your service in your area, your competitors get those clients.

What to do

- Clear titles and descriptions on every page
- A complete Google Business Profile with reviews
- Direct answers to your clients’ questions

Quick test

- [ ] Search for your service and your city on Google and ChatGPT. Does your business show up?

08

You can’t update it yourself

If changing a price or adding a project means asking for help and waiting, the website falls behind. And an outdated website looks careless.

What to do

- Make sure you can edit day-to-day content yourself
- Ask for training at the end of any project
- Keep the domain and logins in your name

Quick test

- [ ] Could you change a line of text on your website today, without help?

How many signs did you tick?

0–1	Your website is in good shape. Keep it up to date and review it once a year.
2–3	A few targeted fixes will make a quick difference. Start with signs 1, 3 and 4.
4 or more	A redesign is probably the most effective option, and cheaper than patching things one by one.

Want a second opinion?

I can redesign your homepage for free and send you a personalised report on what to improve, so you can see the potential before you decide.

Request a free redesign

Book a call

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